

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1067

By Crawford

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Bristol Rhythm & Roots Reunion on the occasion of its twenty-fifth anniversary.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing those cultural institutions that preserve the history, heritage, and artistic traditions of this State while contributing to its economic vitality; and

WHEREAS, for twenty-five years, Bristol Rhythm & Roots Reunion has brought together musicians, artists, residents, and visitors from across the nation and around the world to celebrate Bristol's unique role as the "Birthplace of Country Music"; and

WHEREAS, established in 2001, Bristol Rhythm & Roots Reunion is a community-driven, grassroots project that honors the deep musical traditions of Appalachia and fosters a shared appreciation for roots music, cultural heritage, and creative expression; and

WHEREAS, over the years, the festival has grown into one of the region's premier cultural events, serving as a nationally recognized showcase for Appalachian music and arts while reinforcing Bristol's identity as a center of musical innovation and authenticity; and

WHEREAS, Bristol Rhythm & Roots Reunion has generated significant economic benefits for the region by attracting tourism, supporting local businesses, creating jobs, and contributing to the long-term revitalization of downtown Bristol and surrounding communities; and

WHEREAS, the ongoing success of Bristol Rhythm & Roots Reunion reflects the strength of collaboration between Bristol, Tennessee, and Bristol, Virginia, demonstrating how shared cultural assets can unite communities, strengthen regional partnerships, and advance common economic and civic goals; and

WHEREAS, since 2012, Bristol Rhythm & Roots Reunion has been organized by the Birthplace of Country Music nonprofit organization, which also manages the Smithsonian Institution-affiliated Birthplace of Country Music Museum and the Radio Bristol radio station and invests in education, youth programming, and community engagement to ensure that the region's musical traditions are preserved and passed on to future generations while encouraging new voices and creative growth; and

WHEREAS, the festival's continued success is attributable to the hard work and dedication of numerous organizers, staff members, volunteers, artists, sponsors, and community partners, as well as the visionary leadership of Executive Director Leah Ross; and

WHEREAS, the longevity of Bristol Rhythm & Roots Reunion reflects its sustained excellence, adaptability, and strong community support and underscores its importance as a cultural institution and a model for arts-driven regional development; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Bristol Rhythm & Roots Reunion on the occasion of its twenty-fifth anniversary, expressing our sincere appreciation for its role in preserving Appalachian musical heritage and strengthening regional identity, pride, and collaboration.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.